Their provisions were bought in considerable quantities. The rye for bread was on the floor in an airy room, and was sweet and good. The produce of the prisoners' work was applied to the maintenance of the house, and the deficiency was made up from the spin-house tax. The expense for each prisoner was full five stivers a day. Their number was generally from a hundred and fifty, to two hundred. These prisoners are removed into the new workhouse or house of correction, which at my visit in June 1783, was finished. There were four hundred prisoners.

In the prison at Leeuwarden several were confined for petty offences; but there has been no execution for fourteen years past.

For the refractory, here are two closets, the bottoms and sides of which are pieces of wood placed edgeways, where being confined without shoes, they must be in a painful situation.

In the prison for the military at Groningen there were two prisoners. The gallows joins to the prison.

There is also here a prison for the province. On the gallows, which is placed on elevated ground at a distance from the town, a criminal was hanging (November 1781) who had been executed the year before. In this country malefactors are often thus left to hang after execution, till they drop into a well (or deep pit) underneath, which is designed for the reception of their bones.

In the prison at Zwolle in Overyssel there were no felons, nor has there been an execution there for many years.

The house of correction (Tucht-huys) erected in 1735, is a neat building situated on the ramparts. In November 1781 there were in it seventeen men and twenty-six women. The women were on the first floor in two separate workrooms, spinning and knitting. Nine of them who had been branded were working in a room by themselves; and they had also a separate lodging-room.

At Utrecht, in 1776, I went over the spin-house, the women were separated, according to their crimes. In October 1781, there were fifty men and twenty-six women. Nine women who had been publicly whipped, had a workroom and bedroom separate from the rest.

The overseer or keeper has a house for the residence of himself and his family, and an annual salary of a thousand guilders from the States, and a hundred and thirty from the city, clear of all deductions. By a particular permission from the magistrates, he may take in as boarders, persons of bad behaviour, at the desire of their parents, guardians or relations.

I leave this country with regret, as it affords a large field for information on the important subject I have in view. I know not which to admire most, the neatness and cleanliness appearing in the prisons, the industry and regular conduct of the prisoners, or the humanity and attention of the magistrates and regents.

GERMANY

The Germans, well aware of the necessity of cleanliness in prisons, have very judiciously chosen to build them in situations most conducive to it; that is, near rivers: as at Hanover, Zell, Hamburg, Berlin, Bremen, Cologne, Mentz, and many other places.

In the gaols that I first saw, there were but few prisoners, except those called, improperly, galley-slaves. One cause of this, is a speedy trial after commitment.

The galley-slaves have everywhere a prison to themselves. They work on the roads, the fortifications, chalk-hills, and other public service; for four, seven, ten, fifteen, twenty years, according to their crimes: and are clothed, as well as fed, by the government. At Wesel, which belongs to the King of Prussia, there were ninety-eight of these slaves: they have two pounds of bread a day, and the value of three halfpence every day they work.

I saw but a very few underground dungeons in any new prisons abroad; in Germany none, except at Liege. At Lunenburg the dungeons are disused: and instead of them are built additional rooms upstairs; one for each prisoner. And in many of the gaols each criminal is alone in his room; which is more or less strong, lightsome, and airy, as the crime he is charged with is more or less atrocious.

One often sees the doors of sundry rooms marked Ethiopia, India, Italy, France, England, etc. In those rooms, parents, by the authority of the magistrates, confine for a certain term dissolute children: and if they are inquired after, the answer is, they are gone to Italy, England, etc.

I do not remember any prison in Germany (nor elsewhere abroad) in which felons have not, either from the public allowance, or from charities, somewhat more to live on than bread